1.3 Mobile devices

In this lesson

You will learn:

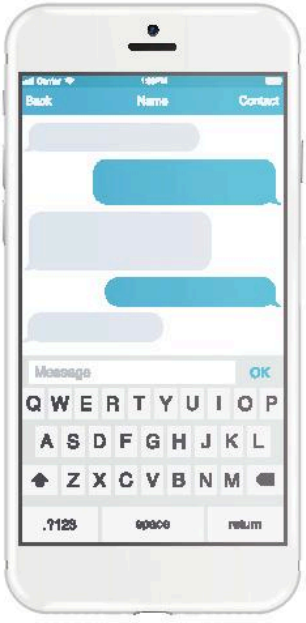
➔ about the features of mobile devices.



Touchscreen

Some computers have a **touchscreen**. A touchscreen is used for input and output.

- The screen shows you pictures, words and video.
- You can touch the screen to tell the computer what to do.



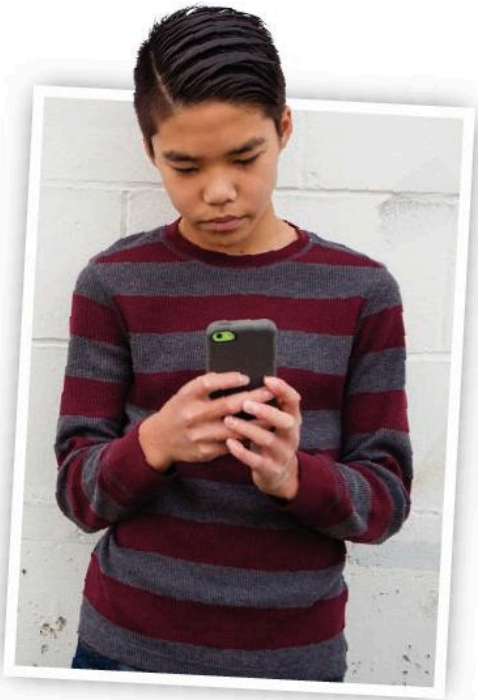
If you have a touchscreen, you do not need a keyboard. A picture of a keyboard appears on the screen. You can touch the screen to use the keys.

Hand-held computers

A computer with a touchscreen can be very small and light. You can hold it and use it in your hands. You can carry it with you wherever you go. Computers like this are called **hand-held** computers. Another name is a **mobile device**.

A **tablet computer** has quite a big screen. It is about as big as a book.

A **smartphone** is a mobile phone with a computer inside. It is much smaller than a tablet.





What are mobile devices used for?

People use mobile devices to look at the internet. Mobile devices have a wireless connection.

- A tablet uses the wireless network in a building. For example, there may be a wireless network in your school or home.
- A smartphone has its own internet connection. You can use it outdoors, in the country or the town.

People use mobile devices mainly to look and read. They might watch a TV show or read a website. They might type a short message to a friend. They might type quick notes.

People do not usually use mobile devices to make a big document with lots of typing.



Activity

Write a list of all the digital devices you can see in this picture.





Extra challenge

Choose one of the people in the picture. Write a paragraph about:

- what type of digital device they are using
- what they might be doing with it.

You can write about anything you like.

Think again

What are the differences between a smartphone and a tablet?

1.4 Computers at work

In this lesson

You will learn:

➔ how computers are used in different jobs.

The doctor



Doctors help you when you are sick. They help you to get better.

Computers can help the doctor do her work. For example, the doctor can use the computer to:

- find out about diseases and treatments
- send messages to doctors in other hospitals
- make appointments for patients
- look inside the human body to take accurate pictures and measurements
- print out charts and diagrams to help spot illness
- store facts about patients
- control machines to care for a patient day and night.

The shopkeeper



Shopkeepers help you. They help you buy the things you need.

Computers can help the shopkeeper do his work. For example, the shopkeeper can use the computer to:

- sell things on the internet to people all over the world
- find out about new products
- store facts about the items for sale

- add up your bill quickly and accurately
- make colourful posters and leaflets to advertise
- take payments from customers
- pay wages to staff
- store food at an even temperature at all times.



Activity

Think of a job you would like to do when you become an adult. Think of one way you might use a computer in that job. Draw and write to show how you would use a computer.











Extra challenge

You may not use a computer in all parts of the job. Draw and write to show the things you would do without a computer.

Think again

Talk to an adult who has a job, for example, someone in your family. Ask them if they use a computer. Find out how the computer helps them.